

Impact Medium · Difficulty Easy · Misuse risk Low

THE MOVE

Notice the specific work -> Name it aloud -> Do not qualify

START HERE

Name one piece of effort you noticed today that would normally go unacknowledged. Say it without qualifying it or immediately moving on.

SAY THIS

Effort Acknowledge...	<i>"I can see how much work went into that."</i>
Specific Effort	<i>"The preparation you put into that meeting was clear."</i>
Quick Acknowledge...	<i>"I saw the hours in that. Thank you."</i>
Professional Acknow...	<i>"Before we review the outcome, I want to acknowledge the work rate that got us here."</i>
Effort Repairs	<i>"I went straight to feedback yesterday and skipped over the work itself. That was wrong — the effort was enormous."</i>

AVOID

- When the effort was poor and naming it implies the outcome is acceptable.
- When managing underperformance — naming effort can inadvertently reward the wrong behaviour.
- When your acknowledgement would be read as performative because no real follow-through is planned.

REMEMBER

Acknowledge before you ask for the next thing.